Teacher Facilitation Insert

Reading Level C (Grade 3)

S3 CH05 — The Potter's Valley

Season 3: Makers and Creators

Timing for Level C

Phase	Duration	Key Activity
Launch	5 min	Vocabulary introduction with gestures and morphology
Explore	10 min	Episode viewing with 3 pause discussions
Apply	18 min	Reading passage + comprehension + vocabulary practice
Practice	10 min	Written response paragraph with starter
Share	4 min	Small-group accountable talk + portfolio
Total	**47 min**	

Materials Checklist

- ☐ Episode queued or Read-Aloud Backup ready
- ☐ Vocabulary word cards visible to all students
- ☐ Student packs (one per student)
- ☐ Pencils and erasers
- ☐ Accountable talk stems posted on board

Facilitation Notes for Level C

Launch: Students write "before" and "after" definitions in vocabulary table. Introduce morphology notes (root words).

Chapter 5: The Potter's Valley

Reading Level C • Season 3: Makers and Creators

L — Launch: Vocabulary

My Vocabulary Journal

Before watching the episode, write what you think each word means. After watching, you'll learn the real definition!

Word	Before: I think this means...	After: Now I know...	Morphology Note
kiln (KIL-n)			*Old English:* cyln (furnace)
vessel (VES-sel)			*Latin:* vascellum (small vase)
symmetry (SIM-muh-tree)			*Greek:* syn (together) + metron (measure)
patient (PAY-shent)			*Latin:* patiens (enduring)
craft (KRAFT)			*Old English:* craeft (skill, art)

Context Sentence Practice: Choose one vocabulary word and write a sentence using it in a way that shows you understand what it means.

E — Explore: Episode Viewing

Listening Guide

As you watch the episode, we will pause three times. Write your thoughts at each pause.

Pause 1 (~2:00)

What did you notice when the Potter explained how to work with clay?

_____

_____

_____

Pause 2 (~4:48)

Why do you think Celeste says "center yourself first"?

_____

_____

_____

Pause 3 (~7:12)

What do you predict will happen as the friends keep practicing pottery?

_____

A — Apply: Reading

The Ancient Craft of Oaxacan Pottery

As you read, underline the sentence that best explains WHY pottery takes practice.

In the villages of Oaxaca, Mexico, potters have made black clay pottery for over two thousand years. This ancient **craft** requires skill, time, and complete attention.

Before a potter can create anything, the clay must be prepared. The potter digs clay from the earth and removes rocks and sticks. Then the clay is wedged by pushing and folding it over and over. This removes air bubbles that would make the clay explode in the **kiln**. Wedging takes strong arms and patience.

Next, the potter centers a ball of clay on a spinning wheel. The potter's wet hands press gently but firmly. The clay must spin perfectly before shaping can begin. If the potter rushes, the clay collapses. Centering requires a calm mind and steady hands.

Once centered, the potter opens the clay and pulls the walls up carefully. Too much pressure creates holes. Too little does nothing. The potter must feel the clay's thickness and moisture. This touch takes years to develop.

After shaping, the **vessel** dries slowly for several days. Then it goes into the kiln for firing. The kiln reaches temperatures over 1,500 degrees. The firing process takes many hours. When the vessel emerges, soft clay has become hard pottery that lasts for generations.

CA CCSS for ELA/Literacy: RI.3.1, RI.3.4

A — Apply: Comprehension

Understanding the Text

Answer each question using evidence from the passage.

1. What must potters do to clay before they can shape it?

A) Fire it in the kiln
B) Let it dry for several days
C) Wedge it to remove air bubbles
D) Paint it with glaze

My answer: _____

2. According to the passage, why does the vessel dry slowly after shaping?

A) To make it stronger
B) To prevent cracking
C) To save time
D) To add decorations

My answer: _____

3. Find a sentence in the passage that shows pottery requires patience. Write it here:

_____

_____

_____

4. Why does the author mention that this pottery tradition has lasted "over two thousand years"? What does that tell you about the craft? (2-3 sentences)

_____

_____

A — Apply: Vocabulary in Context

Vocabulary Practice

Use context clues from the passage to answer these questions.

1. Read this sentence from the passage:

> *"This removes air bubbles that would make the clay explode in the kiln."*

What does "kiln" mean in this sentence?

_____

_____

How do you know? What clues did you use?

_____

_____

2. Read this sentence from the passage:

> *"When the vessel emerges, soft clay has become hard pottery that lasts for generations."*

What is a "vessel" based on this passage?

_____

_____

What word in the sentence helps you understand this?

_____

P — Practice: Written Response

My Response

Write a paragraph explaining your thinking. Use evidence from the episode and the reading passage.

Prompt: Patience is important in pottery because ____

Remember: claim → evidence → explanation

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Check your work:

- ☐ Did you include at least one vocabulary word from today's lesson?
- ☐ Did you give a specific example from the episode or passage?
- ☐ Did you explain WHY your evidence matters?

CA CCSS for ELA/Literacy: W.3.1, W.3.2

S — Share: Accountable Talk

Discussion Protocol

Work with your small group. Use these sentence stems to share your ideas.

Accountable Talk Stems

- "I noticed that ____"
- "I agree with ____ because ____"
- "I have a different idea: ____"

What I shared with my group:

_____

_____

_____

Something interesting someone else said:

_____

_____

_____

Our group's most important idea:

_____

_____

_____

MY LEARNING JOURNAL

Season 3: Makers and Creators
Chapter 5: The Potter's Valley

Name: _____ Date: _____

S — Share: Portfolio

My Reflection

What did you learn about patience or craft today?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

How I Did Today

1	2	3	4
I'm just starting	I'm getting there	I've got this	I can teach someone

Circle your rating: 1 2 3 4

I want to get better at:

_____

_____